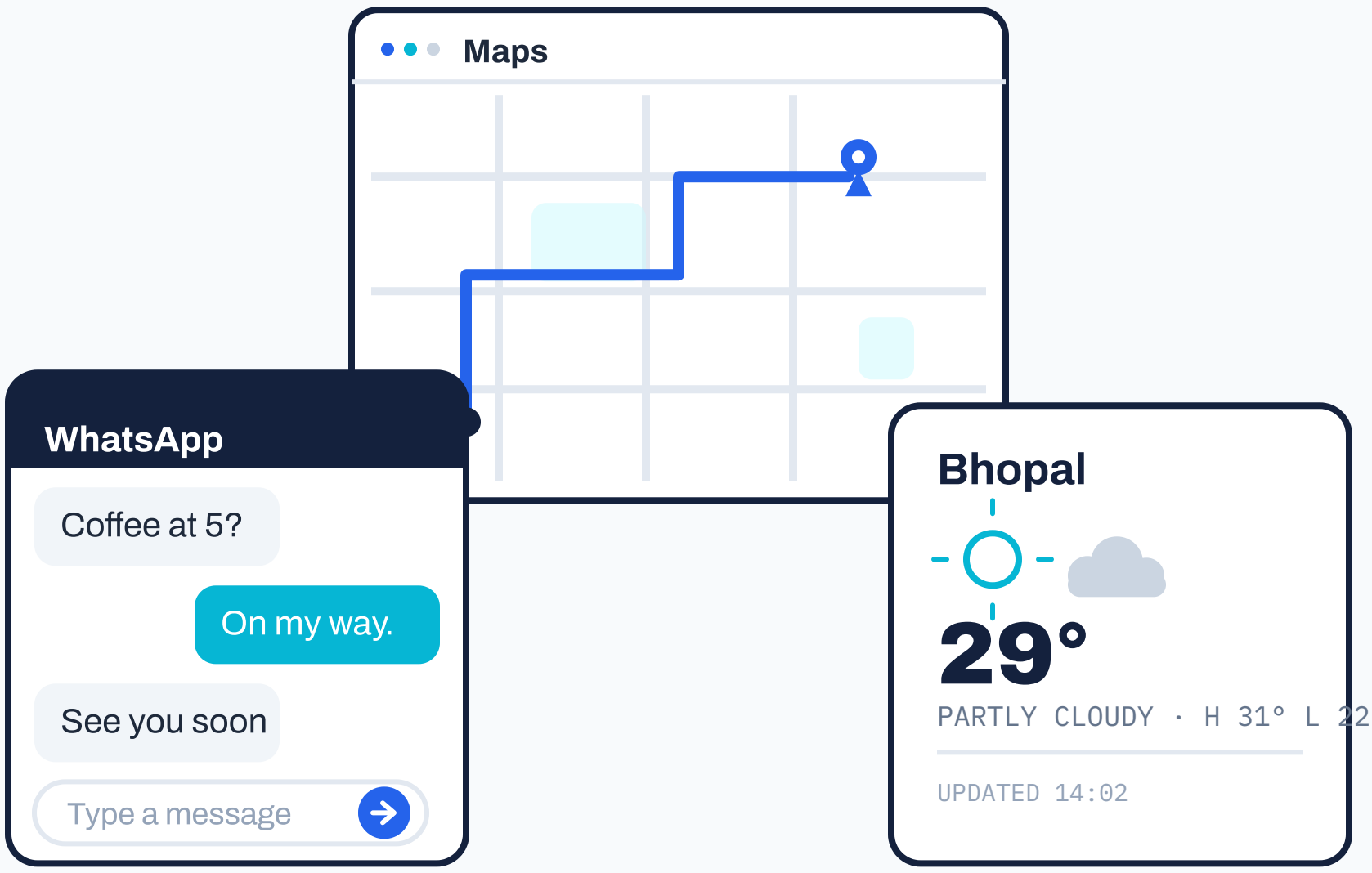
WHAT DOES API ACTUALLY MEAN?

Three words. One term that powers modern software.

A	APPLICATION	the software
P	PROGRAMMING	the instructions
I	INTERFACE	the connection

APPLICATION

An application is a software program designed to help its user perform a task.



WHATSAPP — messaging

GOOGLE MAPS — navigation

A WEATHER APP — forecasts

A BANKING APP — payments

TAKEAWAY

An application is software that does something useful for its user.

PROGRAMMING

Programming means writing instructions that tell a computer what to do.

YOU

“Say hello to the world.”

PLAIN ENGLISH

WRITTEN AS PYTHON

hello.py

```python
print("Hello, World!")
```

RUN BY THE COMPUTER

terminal

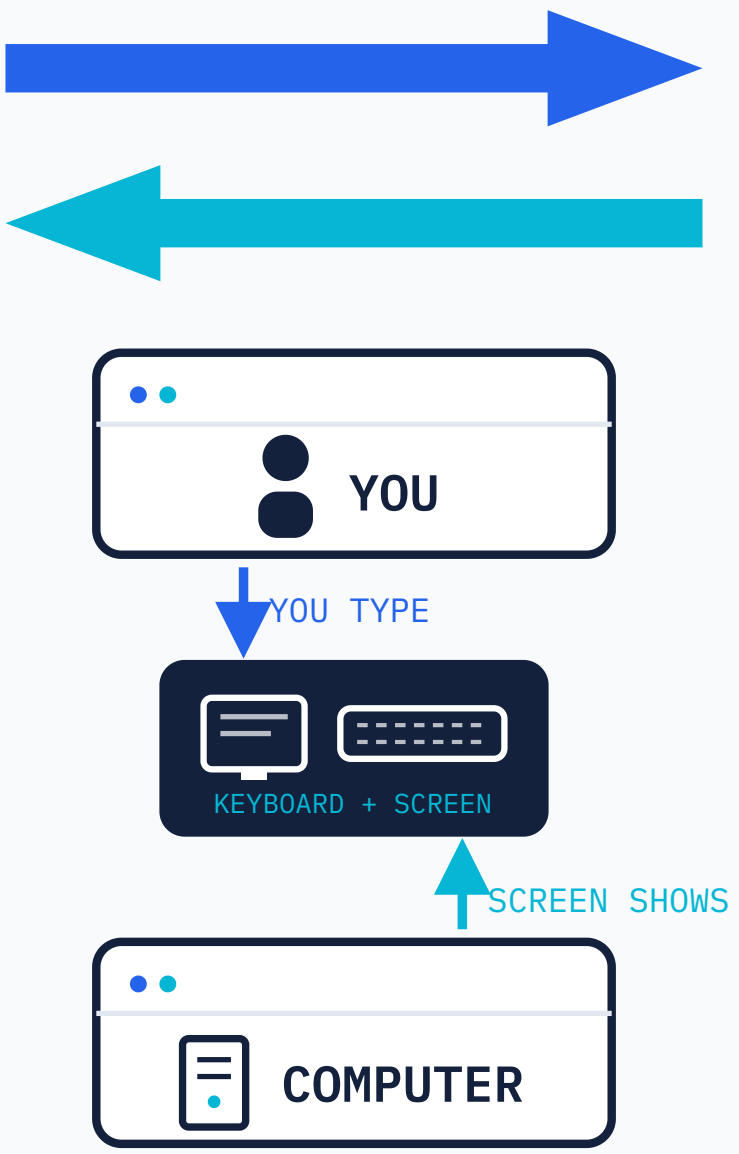
```
$ python hello.py
Hello, World!
```

TAKEAWAY

Programming is how we give instructions to computers.

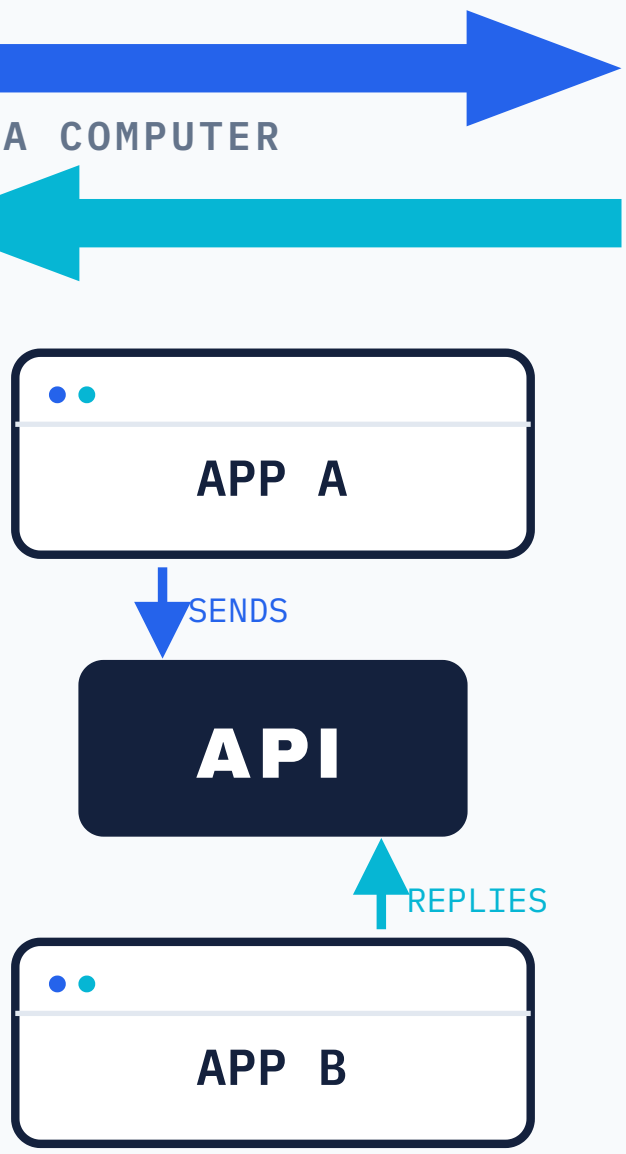
INTERFACE

An interface is a point of interaction or communication between two things.



You press keys. The screen replies. **The keyboard and screen are the interface.**

YOU AND A COMPUTER



TWO AP

One app sends. The other replies. **The API is the interface.**

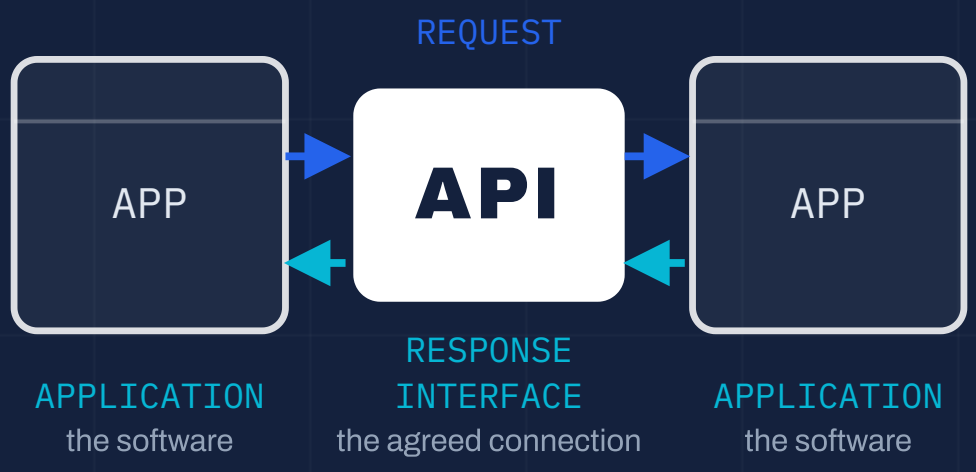
TAKEAWAY

An interface provides a way for two sides to interact

Now, let's put the three words together.

APPLICATION
+ PROGRAMMING
+ INTERFACE

= API

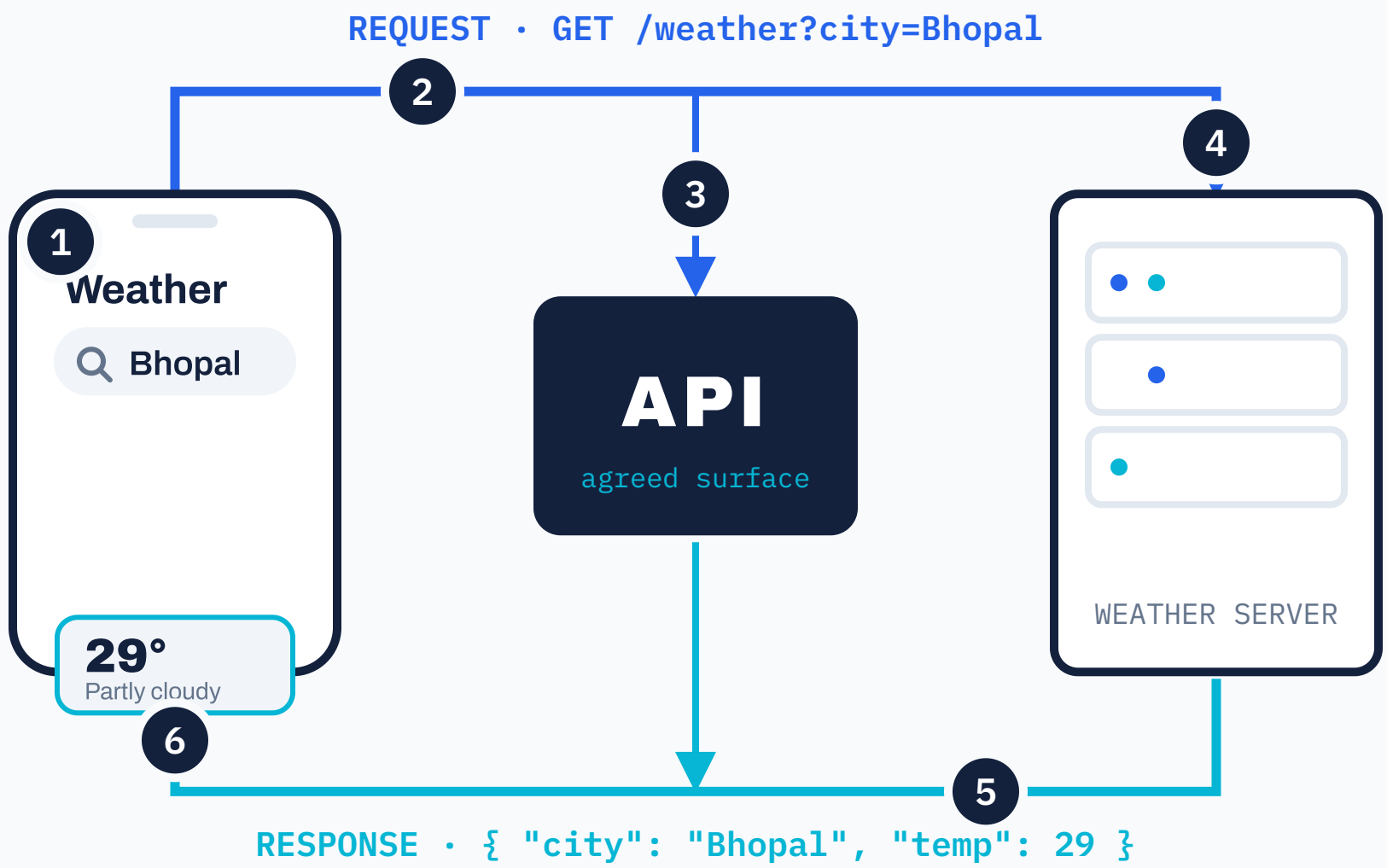


PROGRAMMING
the rules written in code

> **NOTE —** This is a beginner-friendly way to understand the name, not a strict technical definition of how every API is implemented.

Let’s understand it with a weather app.

You open the app and search for **Bhopal**. What happens next?



01 You open the app and search for Bhopal.

02 The app needs weather data it doesn’t have.

03 It sends a request through the API.

04 A weather server processes the request.

05 The server returns the weather data.

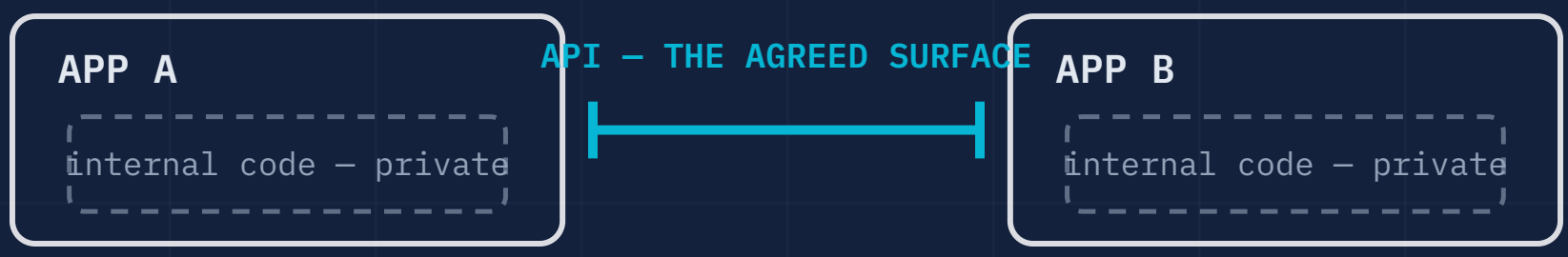
06 The app displays the result on your screen.

So, what does API really mean?

An Application Programming Interface is a defined way for software applications to communicate and interact with each other.

APPLICATION	→	SOFTWARE
PROGRAMMING	→	INSTRUCTIONS + RULES
INTERFACE	→	A WAY TO INTERACT

ONE MORE THING



An API does not mean two applications share their source code. Each keeps its internals **private** and communicates only through the **agreed interface**.

You now understand the name behind API.

A **APPLICATION** = Software

P **PROGRAMMING** = Instructions

I **INTERFACE** = Way to interact

COMING NEXT — PART 03

How does an API request and response actually work?

> > >

Save this post if you're learning backend development.